



Linus Torvalds shares 'Tech Nobel' with Shinya Yamanaka

Linus Torvalds, the Linux kernel creator, shared the 2012 Millennium Technology Prize, also known as 'Tech Nobel', with Shinya Yamanaka, the Japanese physician and stem cell researcher. They both have received an equal cut of the €1.2 million prize.

The President of the Republic of Finland, Sauli Niinistö, presented the prize on June 14, 2012, during the ceremony at the Finnish National Opera in Helsinki in front of an audience of scientists and business leaders. This is the first time that the Grand Prize has been shared by two scientists.

Linus Torvalds, a Finnish-American citizen born in Finland, has been awarded the prize for creating the Linux kernel, which was a revolutionary new open source operating system for computers back in 1991 when it was launched. Since then, 73,000 man years have been spent fine-tuning the code. On the other hand, Dr Shinya Yamanaka, a Japanese citizen, has been awarded the prize in recognition of his discovery of a new method to develop induced pluripotent stem cells for medical research. Using his method to create stem cells, scientists all over the world are making great strides in medical drug testing and biotechnology research.

Charles H Schulz announces plans to assist Mandriva

Charles H Schulz said in a post on the official Mandriva blog that he would be assisting the company as an advisor on open source strategy.

"As Mandriva is entering a new phase in its history, it has started an important conversation with the community about the future of the Mandriva Linux distribution, its governance and its goals. My name is Charles H Schulz; you may know me from other Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) projects, and I will be assisting Mandriva and its community in defining our future and how best we will serve the interests of the community, of software freedom, and of Mandriva SA," he added.

Schulz was earlier involved in the founding of the Document Foundation. At present, he is a board member of the Document Foundation, which created the LibreOffice fork of OpenOffice.



Facebook releases Folly software components to the public

It is a well-known fact that the social networking giant, Facebook, uses Linux to run its site. Moving closer to the open source world, the company has now released Folly, its library of C++ software components that it had so far used only internally, to the public. This will aid in making more programs open source.

This will even simplify Facebook's internal procedures. Previously, whenever Facebook needed to make any open source releases, it had to rewrite the complete internal library functions. But this new initiative will change that. Computer engineers working in heavy production environments will find this library useful because it has many components that run faster than their equivalents. Folly primarily contains equivalents of two common C++ standard library utilities. These are `std::string` and `std::vector`. Detailed

Linux Foundation announces the 2012 Linux Scholarship Programme

Keeping in mind the increasing demand for Linux professionals, the Linux Foundation announced its 2012 Linux Training Scholarship Programme. It has also announced the new Enterprise Linux Training programme, which aims at preparing the next generation of enterprise architects.

The annual scholarship programme extends the reach of Linux training opportunities by awarding five scholarships to computer science students, Linux developers and architects who show incredible promise for helping to shape the future of Linux but do not otherwise have the ability to attend Linux Foundation training courses. Each scholarship will cover the expense for one course from The Linux Foundation's course catalogue, a value averaging more than \$2,500.

Scholarship applicants are invited to fill out a brief submission form online at: <https://training.linuxfoundation.org/2012-linux-training-scholarship-program>. Winners will be selected based on demonstrated need, proven interest in working on Linux and their vision for the future of the operating system.

Submissions are due by 12:01 a.m., PT on July 11, 2012 and will be reviewed by The Linux Foundation. Recipients will be notified in early August.

The Linux Foundation will provide vendor-neutral, technically advanced training in Linux systems administration, networking, security and cloud computing. While there are a variety of enterprise Linux training programmes around, The Linux Foundation is expanding its programme to train enterprises that have technology as the core strategy of their businesses, and are optimising Linux and open source for competitive advantage.